



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*nirvṛtiḥ prāpyate samyak | satata+indriya+tarpaṇāt |
saṃtarpita+indriyatayā | manaḥ+svāsthyam avāpyate | | 12.104 |
sva+stha+prasanna+manasaḥ | samādhir* upapadyate |
samādhi+yukta+cittasya | dhyāna+yogaḥ pravartate | | 12.105 |
dhyāna+pravartanād* dharmāḥ | prāpyante yair* avāpyate |
dur+labhaṃ* śāntam a+jaraṃ* | paraṃ* tad* a+mṛtaṃ* padam | | 12.106 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 12, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The journey towards enlightenment, as illuminated by the Buddhacarita, unveils a pathway accessible to each of you. This passage describes a gradual unfolding, a process of refining your experience to ultimately reach a state of profound peace. It begins by acknowledging the role of the senses. Initially, the gratification of the senses, constant sensory stimulation, leads to a sense of well-being. When your senses are satiated, a kind of contentment arises within the mind.

This contentment, however, is merely the starting point. It is from a mind that feels at ease, a mind that is "sva-stha" – literally, standing in its own place – that true spiritual progress can begin. This settled and clear mind is fertile ground for samadhi, a state of deep concentration. When your mind is focused and unwavering, you can then enter into dhyana, meditative absorption.

Dhyana, in turn, unlocks the gateway to Dharma, to the profound truths of existence. It is through consistent meditative practice that you begin to perceive the nature of reality with increasing clarity. This perception ultimately leads to the realization of that rare and precious state: a realm of tranquility, free from aging and decay, the supreme and immortal state of Nirvana.

In modern life, bombarded by sensory overload and constant distractions, this passage offers a vital reminder. It encourages you to first acknowledge your sensory experiences, to find a degree of balance and contentment in your everyday life. But it also cautions against becoming overly attached to sensory gratification. True and lasting happiness does not come from fleeting pleasures, but from cultivating inner peace through mindfulness and meditation. By tending to your mind, by creating space for stillness, you can embark on your own journey towards enlightenment, towards that "supreme and immortal state."

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you create more moments of stillness in your busy life to cultivate a mind that is "sva-stha," standing in its own place?